

Security Footage of Apartment

The security camera footage is digitized and top of the line for a residential apartment complex. Unlike at the storage unit, the images have sharp resolution and cover multiple angles. Kerry Houghton did not leave the apartment all day Thursday, 18 AUG 2016. The only camera angles depicting her unit are a high-angle shot of the parking lot in front of Building 12 and a shot of the stairwell on the second floor. Her door is seen in the periphery at the left of the screen. At 12:09 a.m. that night (early 19 AUG 2016), the stillness of the parking lot is interrupted by three figures walking up the stairs. The figures clearly match the two males and one female present on the security footage at the murder scene. The female and one male walk up the north eastern stairwell where the camera is located, while the second male comes into frame from the other open-air stairwell on the southwestern side of the building, which faces a small patch of woods. The two males stack up on either side of the door as if preparing to breach it. The female faces away from the apartment, toward the unit across the hallway. At 12:12 a.m., the door opens and Kerry Houghton becomes visible. She is wearing the clothing she would die in and carries a sack of trash. The two men grab her arms, clamp her mouth shut, and begin striking her about the head. They drag her down the stairs as the woman turns and enters the open door of Houghton's apartment. She is inside for six seconds before exiting again, carrying a dangling keychain. She does not close the door behind her. By this time, the men have beaten Houghton unconscious and dragged her to the parking lot. They wait next to a red 1997 Toyota Corolla. The female assailant exits the stairwell on the ground floor. She finds the car key on the lanyard in one guess and opens the trunk of the Corolla

the car belonged to Houghton. They throw Kerry Houghton in the trunk and get in the vehicle. The car pulls out of the apartment complex before 12:13 a.m. Shortly thereafter, the door to apartment 12121, left ajar by the assailants, closes seemingly by itself. The glare from the light differential between the lit apartment and dim hallway makes it impossible to see why.